

Mean vs Median: Deal or No Deal

On the show *Deal or No Deal*, contestants choose from 26 suitcases. These are the amounts inside them (\$0.01 is one cent):

\$0.01	\$1	\$5	\$10	\$25	\$50	\$75	\$100	\$200
\$300	\$400	\$500	\$750	\$1,000	\$5,000	\$10,000	\$25,000	\$50,000
\$75,000	\$100,000	\$200,000	\$300,000	\$400,000	\$500,000	\$750,000	\$1,000,000	

- a) What is the median amount?
- b) What is the mean amount?
- c) Are the median and the mean close to each other? Why or why not?
- d) What proportion of the prize amounts are bigger than the mean?
- e) What proportion of the prize amounts are bigger than the median?

Data for a Spreadsheet

Copy this table (including the Amount heading) and paste it into cell A1 of a spreadsheet. The amounts are in dollars.

Amount
0.01
1
5
10
25
50
75
100
200
300
400
500
750
1000
5000
10000
25000
50000
75000
100000
200000
300000
400000
500000
750000
1000000